



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 44: Meeting Management

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Meetings

- ❖ *“Meetings fulfil a deep human need. Man is a social species. In every organization and every human culture of which we have record, people come together in small groups at regular and frequent intervals, and in larger tribal gatherings from time to time. If there were no meetings in places where people work, their attachment to their work would be less, and people would meet in societies, clubs, or pubs when work was over.”*
- Antony Jay, ‘How to Run a Meeting’
- ❖ *“Meetings are the fulcrum...the central nervous system of an information society, the centre stage for personal performance.”*
- George David Kieffer, ‘The Strategy of Meetings’



Purposes of Meetings

✓ To share information and issues

✓ To generate new ideas

✓ To exchange ideas, and experiences

✓ To arrive at widely acceptable decisions



✓ To communicate information to a group

✓ To discuss new ideas, proposals and plans

✓ To discuss and sort out complex situations

✓ To resolve conflicts and confusions

Functions of Meeting

- ❑ **Develops team spirit:** Meetings are often the exclusive platforms where focus shifts from individual aspirations and concerns of employees to the broader goal and vision of the organization at large.
- ❑ **Germinates group culture:** Meetings provide a conducive stage to enable group learning. Knowledge and experiences are pooled-in and shared among the members.
- ❑ **Clarifies collective purpose and focus:** The workgroup is motivated towards sharing a collective responsibility of getting the task done. Meetings also facilitate members to understand how their contributions align with the work of other members and with the group's mission.
- ❑ **Demonstrates status:** Meetings serve to showcase the position, influence, expertise, knowledge and authority of the participants during the process of interaction.
- ❑ **Meetings serve to fulfil the imperative human need of socializing,** i.e. being a part of a group and communicating with other human beings.

Meeting Management

Well-managed meetings



☐ Participants come prepared

☐ Entails a sense of accomplishment

☐ Produces effective results

Unplanned meetings



☐ Poorly organized; poorly directed

☐ Lack of focus

☐ Many digressions; easily diverted away from the agenda

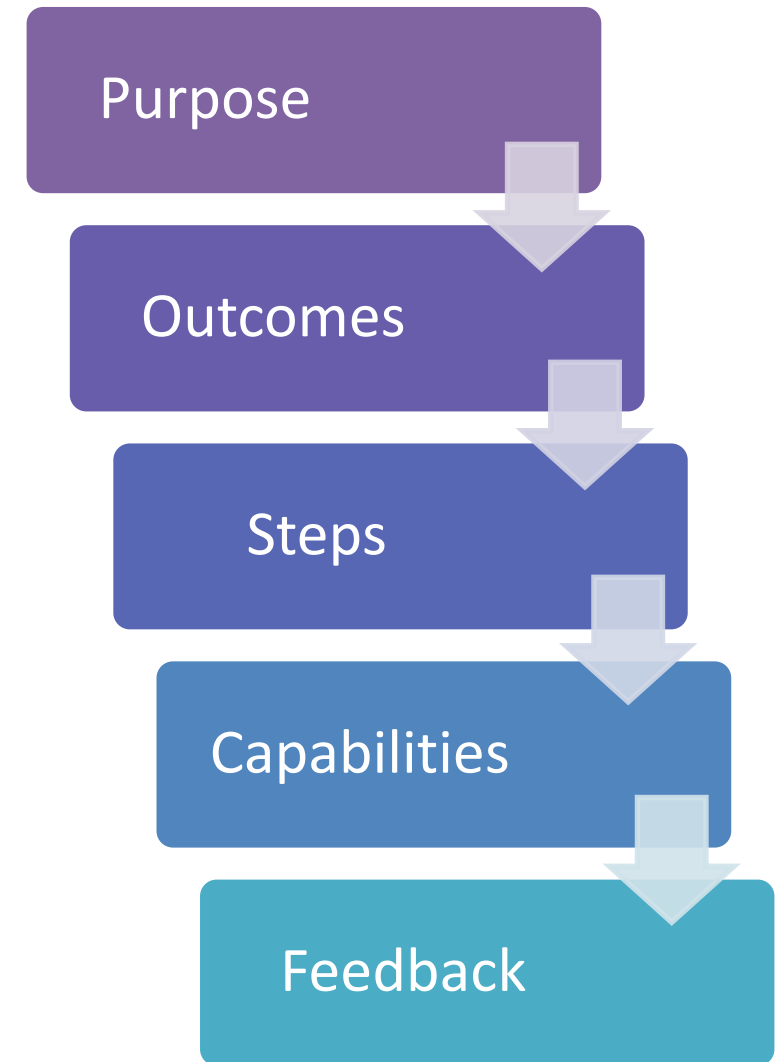
Meeting Management: The Process Cycle

1. Purpose: “Why are we having this meeting?”

- Discuss on the proposed purposes of the meeting
- Reach a consensus on what the purposes are and are not, to dispel any false expectations and to help keep the discussion focussed.
- Mention clearly the purpose/s of the meeting

2. Outcomes: “What will we take away from this meeting?”

- Develop understandable, measurable or observable outcomes
- Outcome statements should indicate the benefits that the participants and other stakeholders will derive from the successful realization of the meeting
- Clearly stated outcomes keep the discussion on track, and also serve as a basis for evaluating the meeting



Meeting Management: The Process Cycle (Contd...)

Steps

- Determine the steps to be taken before, during and after the meeting to achieve the desired outcome.
- Ensure the fulfilment of pre- meeting and post meeting assignments.

Capabilities

- Who needs to be present at the meeting and who should not be present?
- What should be the ground rules for behavior at the meeting?
- What resources are essential for conducting the meeting?
- Who is assigned with the responsibility of arranging for the resources?

Feedback

- The criteria for evaluation of the meeting
- Learnings derived from the meeting experience
- Suggestions to continually improve upon the standard of meetings

Roles in a Meeting

❑ Chairperson:

- ✓ Provides overall leadership for the meeting.
- ✓ Aligns the group members to the meeting – states the purpose, agenda, significance and expected outcomes.
- ✓ Builds a climate for discussion and open dialogue.

❑ Group Members:

- ✓ Share collective responsibility for the success of the meeting – obey the ‘ground rules’.
- ✓ Commit to the schedule defined.
- ✓ Show active participation – share ideas, respond to questions, give feedback.
- ✓ Contribute productively – State your input/idea – Situate your idea within the context of the meeting – Corroborate your idea with reasoning and evidence – Ask the participants for feedback on your input.
- ✓ Demonstrate active listening skill.
- ✓ Pay attention to process, to content and to outcomes of the meeting.
- ✓ Follow up on the action plan agreed upon at the meeting.

Contd...

☐ **Recorder:**

- ✓ Captures the basic idea of speakers visibly – on a white board or a flipchart.
- ✓ Clarifies ambiguous statements and vague ideas.
- ✓ Records the proceedings of the group process – arguments, decisions and actions agreed upon.
- ✓ Prepares and hands out meeting minutes to the participants.

☐ **Process Advisor (Facilitator):**

- ✓ Applies the principles and techniques of group process (decision making, problem solving).
- ✓ Provides suggestions for improvement during the meeting based on his/her observations of the group process.

☐ **Resource Person/Content Expert:**

- ✓ Carries out extensive research on the issues pertaining to the topic of the meeting – brainstorming, organizing the ideas, goal setting, resolving conflicts, problem solving, planning for action, assigning roles.
- ✓ Provides background information to the group when needed.

Roles in a Meeting (contd.)

❑ Timekeeper:

- ✓ Assists the facilitator to keep a track of the schedule of various agendas.
- ✓ Helps the group to start and end on time and to manage time during the meeting.

❑ Process Observer:

- ✓ Monitors the interaction and proceedings of the group.
- ✓ Refrains from active participation in the discussion.
- ✓ Presents a report at the conclusion of the meeting.

❑ Administrator

- ✓ Ensures the availability of the booked venue.
- ✓ Checks that the technical equipments are available and working properly.
- ✓ Takes care of refreshments for the group members.

“Each meeting is a miniature management cycle.”

—Richard Dunsing
‘You and I Have Simply Got to Stop Meeting This Way’

Chairperson: Responsibilities

“Just as the driver of a car has two tasks, to follow his route and to manage his vehicle, so the chairperson’s job can be divided into two corresponding tasks, dealing with the agenda items and dealing with the people.” — Antony Jay, ‘How to Run a Meeting’

Pre-meeting

- Facilitate the development of agenda.
- Ensure that the meetings are well-planned with clear agenda and defined outcomes.
- Communicate the agenda to the participants well in advance.
- Assign meeting roles (of facilitator, resource person, time-keeper, recorder, etc.).

Post-meeting

- Review the meeting – its success as well as fall-backs.
- Prepare notes on the outcomes of the meeting.
- Ensure that meeting minutes are accurate and are sent to the members on time.
- Schedule next meeting pertaining to the topic at hand.

Continued...

Beginning the Meeting

- ✓ Encourage participation.
- ✓ Promote a positive, amicable milieu.
- ✓ Define meeting purpose/objective.
- ✓ Set ground rules.
- ✓ Define the roadmap of the meeting.
- ✓ Mention the processes to be used for decision making and conflict resolution.

Facilitating the Meeting

- ✓ Start discussion on each item of the agenda.
- ✓ Keep the meeting directed towards defined outcomes.
- ✓ Encourage and compliment the members.
- ✓ Enforce the stated group agreements as needed.
- ✓ Handle digressions and resolve misunderstandings.

Concluding the Meeting

- ✓ Summarize the outcomes and the takeaways.
- ✓ Reiterate action plans and remind the timelines agreed upon.
- ✓ Applaud the group on work accomplished.
- ✓ Discuss whether further meetings on the topic are required.
- ✓ Define preliminary agenda of the next meeting (if required).

Meeting Notice



- ❑ To conduct a meeting, send a written notice to all members of the group at least one week prior to the date of meeting.

- ❑ The notice for meeting should include:
 - ❖ The name and address of the organization
 - ❖ The date of issuing
 - ❖ The date and day of meeting
 - ❖ The time and venue of the meeting
 - ❖ The business of the meeting (should be included in the notice if the number of items is less; else, should be enclosed with the notice as annexure)

Notice

August 10, 2022

The second meeting of the Executive Committee will be held on **Wednesday, 25 August, 2022**, at **5 P.M** in **Room No. 16, Sehgal House**. The agenda is enclosed herewith.

Please make it convenient to attend the meeting.

Arvind Kukreja
Secretary

Meeting Agenda

- ❑ Agenda refers to an official list of items of business to be transacted at a particular meeting.

Elements of the meeting agenda

- The purpose of the meeting
- The expected outcomes of the meeting
- The date, time and venue of the meeting
- The schedule of the meeting
- The list of participants and their roles in the meeting
- For each item on the agenda - note the member responsible for it, the time allocated for the item and the outcome being sought
- Clarify prerequisites of the meeting (as background read)

Agenda

10.00 - 10.05 project update
10.05 - 10.15 review change schedule
10.15 - 10.25 bug report summary
10.25 - 10.35 survey results + outcomes
10.35 - 10.45 review actions

- ✓ To define the purpose of the meeting
- ✓ To plan the meeting content and flow
- ✓ To define expected results
- ✓ To assign responsibility for each item enlisted in the agenda
- ✓ To conduct meeting in proper order
- ✓ To ensure continuity in the proceedings
- ✓ To keep the meeting on track
- ✓ To follow the schedule of the meeting

Purpose of the meeting agenda

Guidelines for Preparing Agenda

- ❑ Place agenda items **in increasing order of their importance**.
- ❑ **Enumerate** each item on the agenda.
- ❑ Usually, the agenda **begins with** the confirmation of the minutes of the previous meeting.
- ❑ The **last item** in the list should state as: *'Any other matter with the permission of the Chairperson.'*
- ❑ **Mention the reason** for each topic on the agenda.
- ❑ Put **times on agenda items**, and stick to the schedule.

Continued...

- ☐ Don't introduce a new item 15 minutes prior to the lunch break or the winding up of the meeting.
- ☐ Aim for **1-hour meetings** (maximum for 2 hours).
- ☐ Place **agenda items of high interest** to the group towards the end of the agenda to reinvigorate the energy and enthusiasm of the members.
- ☐ The chairperson should **distribute the agenda well in advance** for the participants to prepare accordingly.
- ☐ The pre-distributed agenda should bear the title as the **Proposed Agenda**; it should be finalized with the group at the beginning of the meeting .

“The usual mistake is to make the agenda unnecessarily brief and vague. For example, the phrase ‘development budget’ doesn’t communicate much, whereas the longer explanation ‘to discuss the proposal for reduction of the [next year’s] development budget now that the introduction of our new product has been postponed,’ guides members to form views or even look up facts and figures in advance.”

—Antony Jay, *‘How to Run a Meeting’*

Minutes of the Meeting

- ❑ Minutes refer to the official records of the business transacted at the meeting.

Elements of minutes of the meeting

- Date, location, duration, times of commencement and adjournment of the meeting
- Names of the Chairman, Secretary, members present, members absent, others who performed a special role, and the organization
- Record of the transaction – in the order of the items on the agenda
- The meeting decisions and actions agreed upon
- The person/s responsible for implementing the further course of action and its time frame
- Date, time, place and topic of the next meeting
- Signatures of the Secretary and the Chairman

- ✓ To provide a basis for decision and action post meeting
- ✓ To serve as record and follow-up of the discussion
- ✓ To avoid reworking on the tasks accomplished
- ✓ To preserve a record of the issues discussed and the decisions made
- ✓ To provide inputs for the agendas of subsequent meetings

Purpose of the minutes of the meeting

Guidelines for Writing Minutes of the Meeting

- ❑ Use **agenda of the meeting as the framework** for recording the minutes. Follow the pattern of the agenda and the order of the items enlisted.
- ❑ The style of writing minutes is **impersonal, objective**, matter-of-fact and accurate.
- ❑ Be **brief and concise**. Summarize outcomes, decisions and actions; do not present detailed records.
- ❑ The **recorder can visibly record** the meeting on a flip chart or a whiteboard while the meeting is in progress, this can be used to develop the minutes after the conclusion of the meeting.

“Once approved at the next meeting, the minutes become a record that can help resolve differing interpretations and remind the leader and others of commitments made.”

—M.M. Milstein,
‘Towards More Effective Meetings’

Continued...

- ❑ **Use markers to distinguish** between the records of the decisions and the records of the main points.
- ❑ **In case of a vote for a resolution**, note the names of the proposer, the seconder/s, the number of members voting 'for' and 'against the motion, and whether the resolution was accepted or rejected.
- ❑ The chairperson should **ensure the prompt distribution of the meeting minutes** (ideally within a day or two) to the group members after the conclusion of the meeting.

“Once approved at the next meeting, the minutes become a record that can help resolve differing interpretations and remind the leader and others of commitments made.”

—M.M. Milstein,
'Towards More Effective Meetings'

Group Agreements

- ❖ 'Group agreements' or 'ground rules' refer to the standards of behaviour in a meeting.
- ❖ Introduce ground rules as an early item on the agenda.
- ❖ Write out/ post the rules in a visible location.
- ❖ Discuss the understanding of points and seek approval of the group members before finalizing the ground rules for a meeting.
- ❖ The chairperson with the aid of the facilitator should ensure the adherence of the group to the agreed rules during the entire duration of the meeting.

Our ground rules for talk

1. Everyone should have a chance to talk
2. Everyone's ideas should be listened to
3. Each member of the group should be asked
 - what do you think?
 - why do you think that?
4. Look and listen to the person talking
5. After discussion, the group should agree on a group idea

***“Creativity comes from spontaneous meetings, from random discussions.”
- Steve Jobs***

Thank You

Works Consulted

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